03

DYNAMITE®

TEEN+

SHERLOCK HOLMES

THE VANISHING MAN

MOORE
REPPION
OHTA

SHERLOCK HOLMES™
THE VANISHING MAN

NO. 3

WRITTEN BY
LEAH MOORE & JOHN REPPION

ILLUSTRATED BY
JULIUS OHTA

COLORS BY
ELLIE WRIGHT

LETTERED BY
SIMON BOWLAND

EDITED BY
KEVIN KETNER

COVER BY
JOHN CASSADAY & JOSÉ VILLARRUBIA

DYNAMITE

Nick Barrucci, CEO / Publisher
Juan Collado, President / COO
Brandon Dante Primavera, V.P. of IT and Operations
Rich Young, Director of Business Development

Joe Rybandt, Executive Editor
Matt Idelson, Senior Editor
Anthony Marques, Associate Editor
Kevin Ketner, Associate Editor

Geoff Harkins, Creative Director
Jason Ullmeyer, Art Director
Cathleen Heard, Senior Graphic Designer
Alexis Persson, Graphic Designer
Rachel Kilbury, Digital Multimedia Associate

Alan Payne, V.P. of Sales and Marketing
Pat O'Connell, Sales Manager

Amy Jackson, Administrative Coordinator

www.DYNAMITE.com
Facebook **/Dynamitecomics**
Instagram **/Dynamitecomics**
Tumblr **dynamitecomics.tumblr.com**
Twitter **@dynamitecomics**
YouTube **/Dynamitecomics**

PEFC Certified
Printed on paper from sustainably managed forests and controlled sources
PEFC/01-31-106 www.pefc.org

SHERLOCK HOLMES™: THE VANISHING MAN , VOLUME 1, #3. First printing. Published by Dynamite Entertainment, 113 Gaither Dr., STE 205, Mt. Laurel, NJ 08054. Sherlock Holmes TM & © 2018 Dynamite Characters, llc. "Dynamite" and "Dynamite Entertainment" are ®, and the "DE Logo" is ™ and ©, Dynamite Entertainment. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED. All names, characters, events, and locales in this publication are entirely fictional. Any resemblance to actual persons (living or dead), events or places, without satiric intent, is coincidental. No portion of this book may be reproduced by any means (digital or print) without the written permission of Dynamite Entertainment except for review purposes. **Printed in Canada.**
For information regarding press, media rights, foreign rights, licensing, promotions, and advertising e-mail: marketing@dynamite.com

LONDON, A GREAT COAL-BLACK BEAST WITH EYES AS BRIGHT AS CINDERS.

IMPORTS / EXPORTS

TO PROTECT ITS CUBS, IT DEVOURS THEM WHOLE.

SAFE IN THE DARKNESS OF ITS BELLY, THEY DO NOT DREAM THAT THEY ARE FODDER.

M. Latimer

THEY DO NOT FEEL ITS BITE AS THEY PAY THEIR RENT, AS THEY RIDE THE OMNIBUS.

HOOKHAM'S

THEIR WHOLE LIFE LONG, THEY DO NOT SEE THEY ARE BEING SLOWLY DIGESTED BY IT.

THEY KNOW NOT WHAT THEY NOURISH.

THEIR TACIT CONSENT WRITTEN IN EVERY BREATH AND FOOTFALL.

CONSUMED EACH DAY...

...FROM THE CRADLE TO THE GRAVE.

NECROP

LONDON NECROPOLIS & NATIONAL MAUS

INSPECTOR LESTRADE'S HERE TO SEE YOU, MR. HOLMES.

AH, HE IS LUCKY TO HAVE CAUGHT ME BEFORE I LEAVE.

LUCKY INDEED. DID MRS. HUDSON NOT SAY I HAD CALLED? DID YOU NOT GET MY MESSAGES?

I RECEIVED YOURS! SEND A UNIFORMED OFFICER TO A CERTAIN ADDRESS TO DELIVER A NOTE FROM YOU LIKE A BLOODY POSTMAN. DONE.

THEN HAVE THE POOR BASTARD WATCH THE HOUSE THE WHOLE BLOOMING NIGHT LONG. DONE.

NOW WHAT WILL YOU DO FOR ME? AN ESCAPED CRACKSMAN, AN OFFICER MURDERED INSIDE A STATION...

ADD THAT TO THE TORSOS FOUND LAST WEEK...AND THE SAFETY DEPOSIT BOXES...

ONE THING AT A TIME, LESTRADE, ONE THING AT A TIME.

I MUST WORK THROUGH THESE THINGS IN ORDER.

PRECISELY *HOW* YOU ORDER THESE THINGS IS AN ABSOLUTE BLOODY MYSTERY TO ME!

HOW DID THE HUMBOLDT THING TURN OUT, LESTRADE? WAS IT THE FATHER AS WE THOUGHT?

SHE WENT HOME! WALKED IN THE ***DOOR!***

SIX WEEKS OF OFFICERS PULLED OFF OTHER CASES. COMPLETE WASTE OF TIME AND RESOURCES.

H DIVISION DUMPED A DEAD CHEMIST IN MY LAP THIS VERY MORNING, WHICH IS ***ROBBERY,*** AND NOT A ***MURDER.***

MIGHT I PLAY DEVIL'S ADVOCATE, AND SAY THAT A POLICEMAN'S LIFE IS ALWAYS THUS?

BUT IT'S ***NOT,*** NOT ***THIS*** BAD. CRIMINALS USED TO SLIP UP, TO MAKE ***MISTAKES,*** BUT NOT ***NOW.***

I'M CHASING ***SHADOWS!***

THEN I SHALL ENDEAVOUR TO SHINE A LIGHT OF REASON ON THEM, LESTRADE.

BUT BEFORE I DO, I MUST MAKE A CALL FOR THE CASE I AM ON. WOULD YOU ACCOMPANY US?

I'M NOT GOING TO LET YOU OUT OF MY SIGHT! WHO KNOWS WHEN I MIGHT FIND YOU AGAIN.

THERE IS A CABBIE THAT PASSES HERE AT THIS TIME ON HIS WAY OUT FOR THE DAY, A MISTER NOTLEY. MAY--

MR. HOLMES, SIR?

IT'S ME, SIR. DANIEL. DO YOU RECALL ME, SIR? THE IRREGULARS?

AH, OF COURSE, YOUNG DANIEL. WHAT CAN I DO FOR YOU?

PLEASE, SIR, WE AIN'T SEEN WIGGINS. NOT SINCE YOU SENT FOR 'IM.

I TOLD YOU, HOLMES! DIDN'T I SAY?

SENDING THAT BOY OFF LIKE THAT, IT'S NOT RIGHT!

WIGGINS? THE BOY I SENT FOR MY SOLUTION?

I-I HAD QUITE FORGOTTEN.

I SENT HIM TO LLOYD'S PHARMACY, A FIFTEEN MINUTE WALK.

AND THIS WAS *YESTERDAY* MORNING?

SHAME ON YOU! YOU CAN HARDLY RECALL IT, CAN YOU? SUCH WAS YOUR *CONDITION.*

IT WAS, MR. HOLMES, SIR. AN' NOTHING OF HIM SINCE.

PERHAPS... THE CHANGE FROM THE COIN I GAVE HIM. I BELIEVE I SAID HE COULD KEEP IT.

THEN HE'D HAVE BOUGHT US ALL A GOOD FEED, SIR. BUT HE DIDN'T.

I SHALL FIND WIGGINS, I PROMISE YOU THAT.

I'M GOING TO HOOKHAM'S, AND WHILE I'M THERE, I NEED YOU TO DO A LITTLE JOB.

HOLMES! A BOY IS MISSING ALREADY!

NO TIME, WATSON! INSPECTOR, DIDN'T YOU MENTION A CHEMIST?

HOLMES, WHY ON EARTH WOULD YOUR SOLICITOR BE HERE, AT HIS PLACE OF WORK?

I HAVE THIRTY CASES, MAN! I NEED ASSISTANCE!

AND I WILL, LESTRADE. AS SOON AS WE FINISH HERE I AM ALL YOURS.

SEEMS WE HAVE CAUGHT HOOKHAM'S IN THE MIDDLE OF SOME SPRING CLEANING...

INDEED, WATSON. I CAN ONLY WONDER WHAT HAS PROMPTED IT.

MR. HOLMES. DR. WATSON. HOW NICE TO SEE YOU AGAIN.

I DO NOT BELIEVE MR. HOOKHAM IS EXPECTING YOU?

AH, MR. WITHERS! I HAVE BEEN THINKING ABOUT THAT CASE-FILE YOURSELF AND MR. HOOKHAM PRESENTED ME WITH WHEN LAST WE SPOKE.

I BROUGHT INSPECTOR LESTRADE OF SCOTLAND YARD HERE TO LEND HIS EXPERTISE!

MR. HOLMES SAID SOMETHING ABOUT A MISSING ARCHAEOLOGIST?

'SCUSE ME, GENTS.

NECROPOLIS

...MORE OF A *CURIOSITY,* REALLY...NOT SO MUCH A POLICE MATTER...

WELL, PERHAPS I HAD BETTER BE THE JUDGE OF THAT, EH?

I'M TERRIBLY SORRY, INSPECTOR, I DO NOT RECALL THE PRECISE DETAILS! I SHALL HAVE A JUNIOR BRING YOU THE FILES!

AS YOU WISH, SIR. PERHAPS YOU HAD BETTER SEND THEM ALONG TO THE YARD DIRECTLY.

WHAT WAS THAT ALL ABOUT, HOLMES?

A GOOSE CHASE INSPECTOR! YOU WERE MY BEATER, AND WE SHALL SEE WHAT TAKES FLIGHT!

TELEGRAM FOR YOU, SIR. CAME THROUGH BUT A MOMENT AGO FROM HOOKHAM'S. DIRECT.

AH, MY THANKS.

THIS, YOUNG MAN, IS ONE OF THE WONDERS OF OUR AGE!

INSTANT COMMUNI-CATION!

PHELPS AND MATLOCK MUST TAKE TEN MEN EACH AND SECURE THE LOCK-UPS.

SWITCH THE LIVE SHIPMENTS INTO SECONDARY STORAGE BEFORE SUNDOWN. LEAVE NO TRACE.

THE MISTAKE MOST PEOPLE MAKE IS NOT ONLY TO PLACE ALL THEIR EGGS IN ONE BASKET...

...IT IS TO THEN STORE ALL THOSE BASKETS IN A LOCATION CLEARLY LABELLED *"EGG BASKETS."*

THEN IF SOMEONE COMES TO STEAL-- OR SMASH--THEIR EGGS...WELL, THEY'VE MADE IT VERY, VERY EASY.

"ME? I PUT MY EGGS IN TEN DIFFERENT BASKETS. TWENTY. A HUNDRED EVEN.

"SOME PEOPLE DO NOT EVEN KNOW THAT THEIR BASKETS CONTAIN EGGS.

"SOME KNOW, BUT HAVE NO IDEA WHO THOSE EGGS ACTUALLY BELONG TO.

"ALL THEY KNOW IS THAT THEY MAKE MORE MONEY LOOKING AFTER THEM, THAN IF THEY DON'T.

"BUSINESS IS BOOMING, YOUNG MAN.

"EVERYONE KNOWS THEIR ROLE.

LATIMER

LATIMER

"IF WE HAVE TROUBLE, SAY SOMETHING GOES MISSING...

"SAY SOMEONE LEARNS SOMETHING THEY SHOULDN'T HAVE LEARNED...

...THEN EVERYONE WORKS TOGETHER TO SOLVE THE ***PROBLEM.***

THE TRAIL IS STONE COLD. HOW'M I SUPPOSED TO DO THAT?

WELL, WHERE DID YOU LOSE HIM?

THE LAUNDRY IN CLARENCE COURT.

TRY THERE, THEN! AND MAKE IT QUICK! THERE'S MUCH TO DO!

...F'R ALL THE BLOODY GOOD IT'LL DO ME...

LAUNDRY

WHAT ARE YOU PLAYIN' AT? DRAGGIN' YER FILTHY CARCASS THROUGH MY WASHIN'!

AW SHUT YER PIE HOLE, WILL YER. I'M NOT STOPPIN'!

YOU WANT YER CROWN JEWELS PUTTIN' THROUGH A MANGLE?

ALL RIGHT, DON'T GET YER KNICKERS IN A TWIST, I'LL ONLY BE A MINUTE.

WASTE OF A BLOODY DAY, THIS IS!

WHAT'M I EVEN LOOKIN' FOR, ANYWAY?

NOT LIKE I'M GONNA TRIP OVER 'IM, IS IT?

NOT LIKE 'E'S JUST SITTIN' ABOUT WAITIN' TO BE FOUND!

IF MY OL' MAN COULD SEE ME, 'E'D KNOCK ME INTO NEXT WEEK.

IT BETTER BE WORTH IT...

...THIS BETTER BE THE BLOODY JACKPOT!

DRUGGISTS

I'D SAY ROBBERY, ONLY IT WERE BROAD DAYLIGHT, AND THE CHEMIST IS *DEAD.*

THIS IS WHERE YOU SENT THE BOY?

IT IS, WATSON. NO NEED TO SOUND JUDGMENTAL.

MY GOD, IT'S COMPLETELY RANSACKED! BROAD DAYLIGHT YOU SAY?

INDEED. THE CHEMIST MUST'VE BEEN KILLED IN THE STRUGGLE.

NOT SO. HE WAS DEAD SOME TIME BEFORE.

HE WAS KILLED DEFENDING HIS BUSINESS! I'D LAY MONEY ON IT!

THEN YOU WOULD LOSE YOUR STAKE, INSPECTOR.

HE WAS KILLED OVER *THERE* AND HAD TIME TO BLEED OUT BEFORE HE WAS MOVED *HERE.*

WELL MAYBE THEY MOVED HIM, TO MAKE IT EASIER, LIKE?

THE LOOTERS WERE OPPORTUNISTS WHO SAW HIM DEAD.

HOLMES, YOU MIGHT WANT TO SEE THIS.

WIGGINS WAS HERE ALRIGHT...

...IN THE VERY MIDST OF THINGS, BY THE LOOK OF IT!

Sherlock Hol
221B Ba

I-I COULDN'T KNOW. HOW COULD I KNOW?

I TOLD YOU, MAN! I ***TOLD*** YOU IT WASN'T SAFE!

I-I THOUGHT IT WAS SUCH A SIMPLE THING. AN ERRAND FOR AN ERRAND BOY...I DIDN'T THINK...

I CAN'T. I ***NEED...***

I SHALL SEE YOU BACK AT BAKER STREET.

HOLMES? HOLMES! WHERE THE DEVIL ARE YOU GOING?

HOLD ON TIGHT NOW, FLORENCE! BE CAREFUL!

WINSTON, HOLD ON TO YOUR SISTER PLEASE. DON'T WRIGGLE!

MR. HOLMES SAID IN HIS NOTE THAT I'M TO TELL HIM IF YOU MISBEHAVE!

HE WOULDN'T SEND ***NAUGHTY*** CHILDREN TICKETS FOR THE ZOO, NOW WOULD HE?

POLICEMEN PLAYING FATHER CHRISTMAS, DELIVERING MESSAGES AND GIFTS IN THE DEAD OF NIGHT. A DAY AT THE ZOO. A FINE TO-DO THIS IS!

HOLMES' NOTE SAID HE WANTED US ***SAFE*** SOMEWHERE IN ***PUBLIC,*** AND HE THOUGHT THE CHILDREN WOULD LIKE THE ANIMALS.

WELL, HE WAS RIGHT ABOUT THAT.

SO, WE'RE NOT SAFE AT HOME NOW? IS THAT WHAT THIS MEANS?

OF COURSE WE ARE, IT'S JUST A PRECAUTION WHILE HE'S CARRYING OUT HIS INVESTIGATIONS.

HE'S BEEN ASKING A LOT OF QUESTIONS ABOUT MICHAEL. OTHER PEOPLE ARE LOOKING FOR HIM, TOO.

BUT THEY WON'T FIND HIM, WILL THEY? NOT EVER.

NO. THEY WON'T. WHAT BETTER WAY TO ***PROVE*** THAT THAN TO HAVE ***SHERLOCK HOLMES*** ON THE CASE?

AND WHEN IT'S ALL DONE WE CAN GET ON WITH OUR LIVES IN PEACE.

I HOPE SO, CHILD. I SURELY DO HOPE SO.

MOTHER, LISTEN, I APPLIED FOR SO MANY JOBS, SOON I'LL BE WORKING AGAIN, AND YOU CAN STOP ***WORRYING.*** YOU WILL STOP WORRYING, WON'T YOU?

I'LL STOP WORRYING WHEN THEY STOP LOOKING FOR MICHAEL.

"I JUST PRAY TO GOD MR. HOLMES WORKS HIS MAGIC."

"SO SIMPLE WHEN YOU SEE IT LAID OUT BEFORE YOU.

"WHEN YOU SEE THE INFINITE COMPLEXITY OF THE UNIVERSE AND THOSE COMPLEXITIES RESOLVE THEMSELVES.

"WHEN MYRIAD HURRIED BRUSH STROKES BECOME COLOUR, LIGHT AND SHADOW.

"WHEN A FORM IS GLIMPSED THERE, JUST WAITING TO BE OBSERVED."

"AS A CHILD SEES A PHANTOM IN EVERY CURTAIN FOLD AND FLICKERING CANDLE,

"OR A FLEET OF SHIPS IN EVERY BANK OF CLOUDS.

"SO, MEN SEE MEANING IN A CHAOTIC WORLD, WREST ORDER FROM A TOWER TUMBLED."

...MEANING... IN A CHAOTIC WORLD...

YAARGH!

"AND ALL WHO HEARD SHOULD SEE THEM THERE,

"AND ALL SHOULD CRY, BEWARE! BEWARE!"

WHO'S 'E ON ABOUT? BEWARE OF WHAT?

IT'S 'OW THE PIPE TAKES THEM, AIN'T IT? LET'S GET THIS DONE!

"HIS FLASHING EYES, HIS FLOATING HAIR!

AAGH!

"WEAVE A CIRCLE ROUND HIM THRICE,

"AND CLOSE YOUR EYES...

YAARGH!

"...WITH HOLY DREAD,

"FOR HE ON HONEY-DEW HATH FED,

"AND DRUNK THE MILK OF PARADISE..."

WHOOPS, OUT YOU COME, CHILDREN. IT'S LATE NOW! PAST YOUR BEDTIME.

I NEED THE POTTY, GRANDMA! I NEED TO GO NOW!

HUSH, CHILD! FOR GOODNESS SAKES!

I NEED TO GO, TOO! ON A 'NORMOUS ELEPHANT POTTY!

MRS. WILLIAMS.

GOOD EVENING, OFFICER.

HEAVEN'S ABOVE, HOLD ON WHILE I GET THIS LIT!

I REALLY DO NEED TO GO! I'M NEARLY HAVING AN ACCIDENT!

THERE WE GO CHILDREN, NOTHING TO...

...WORRY ABOUT...

I DON'T UNDERSTAND! I NEVER HEARD A THING!

DR. WATSON? SORRY TO BOTHER YOU, ONLY IT'S HOLMES...

WHUH-- HOLMES? WHAT?

I DON'T KNOW WHAT HE'S UP TO IN THERE, BUT IT SOUNDS LIKE HE'S WRECKING THE PLACE!

GOOD LORD. I'M SO SORRY, MRS. HUDSON.

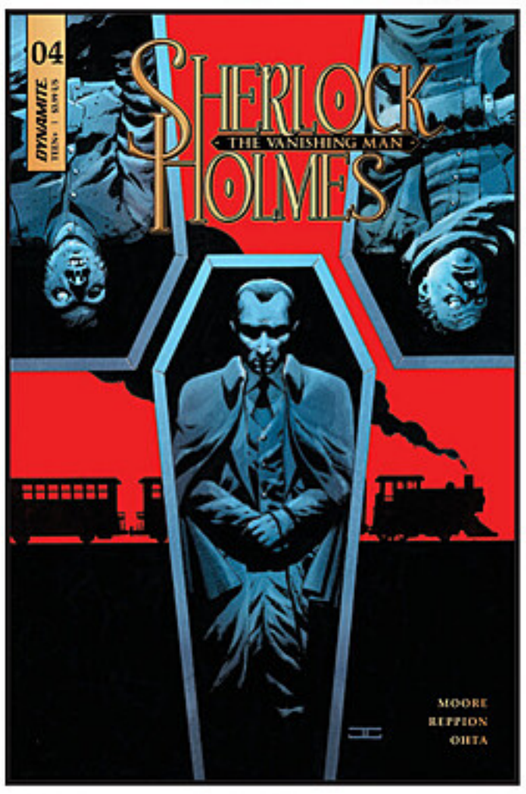
HOLMES? *OH!*

WHAT IN GOD'S NAME?

IT'S SO ***SIMPLE,*** WATSON.

IT'S SO BLINDINGLY ***SIMPLE*** WHEN YOU SEE IT LAID BEFORE YOU!

DYNAMITE DISPATCH
® JULY 2018



FINAL ISSUE

The mystery of Michael Williams comes to its shocking conclusion. But will Holmes and Watson survive the deep running conspiracy gripping London from its very core? And even if they do, are they safe from the machinations of their greatest foe, the all-too-clever Moriarty?

TODD MATTHY CHATS IT UP WITH DYNAMITE ABOUT NEW SERIES: ROBOTS VS. PRINCESSES!

Robots vs. Princesses is one of those titles that seems to tell you a lot in just three words. How did you come up with the idea for this series?

I came up with the series while I was substituting in a first frade classroom. The teacher had coloring pages for when the kids finished their work: robots for boys and princesses for girls. It immediately hit me. From there the wheels started turning. Who are the robots? Who are the princesses? Why are they fighting? What's separating them? I went home and started scribbling notes and next thing I knew, I had a story.

The first one we meet is Princess Zara who appears to be in a school for princesses? What is the world of Harmonia like?

Zara is the youngest Princess at thirteen years old from the Kingdom of Tanglewylde and is a firecracker. Her lack of interest in traditions immediately brought her into conflict High Queen Aleta and her daughter Penelope.

Harmonia is made up of five kingdoms. The Royal Family from one of the kingdoms serves a five- year term as High King and High Queen before the next family takes over. During this period the High Queen serves as headmistress/teacher of the Royal Academy for Princesses, where the Princesses from each kingdom learn how to be good Queens.

Then we get to meet Wheeler who seems to be in a very different world with constant battles raging. What is he like prior to the story?

Because of his small size Wheeler is a whipping bot for the Decimator Warlord Tyrannis and hates his life. He doesn't know why he puts up with it, just assumed it was the role he was assigned when he came off the Assembly Line (where the robots are born). Wheeler's had enough of the abuse and leaves the Decimators.

Now that we know the two leads, what can you tell us about what happens? Them being from different worlds will be an obvious obstacle for them, but what other types of problems might they come across? Is there an actual bad guy and if so, does his name begin with a "T"?

Without giving too much away, Zara and Wheeler put aside their differences fairly quickly. At first the only obstacle Zara and Wheeler face is hiding him from the Queen, but once Tyrannis arrives, their worlds get "decimated!" Tyrannis is the big bad guy and he makes his presence known. The Princesses are Harmonia's and Wheeler's last hope.

What can you tell us about Nicolas Chapuis, the artist on the series? What made him the right choice to draw the book? And what is your working relationship like? Does he get involved in the overall story?

Nic is a treasure. He took two genres that have different art styles and brought them together in a way that it doesn't look like they're intruding on each other. Nic's art is the reason I call this book, "the greatest animated movie never made."

Though the title is a pretty straightforward hook, how would you describe this book in a sentence or two to entice a reader to give it a shot?

All-ages fun that does not talk down to children. The book that bridges the gap between brother and sister while at the same time delighting parents.

I wanted to create a comic for kids that not only respected their intelligence and curiosity, but their desire to become "grown ups." I also wanted to create a comic that parents could read over and over again to their kids and not be bored by. A book they'd enjoy it too. If parents and children want to know what happens next, it'll foster a love of reading and a mutually shared experience.

This book is "all-ages" because there are no four letter words, X-Rated content, or gruesome violence. What is "all-ages," are characters so fascinating that you'll ask "What if…"about what happens next.

All characters and properties are © 2018 their respective owners. Dynamite, Dynamite Entertainment, and its logo are ® & © 2018 Dynamite. All Rights Reserved. All art pending licensor approval.

SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN... THIS MONSTER!"